Parking Penalty Charge Notices: Time Limits for Service by Post

How long an authority has to issue a PCN by post, and the private-parking equivalents.

Short answer: for a council PCN served by post in England, the notice must be issued within **28 days of the contravention**, with a DVLA-delay exception that stretches it to **6 months**. For private parking (ANPR), the keeper notice is much tighter: **14 days**.

Council parking PCN served by post (England)

Deadline to give (issue) a posted PCN — council parking contravention, England

Value: 28 days beginning with the contravention date

> *"Subject to paragraph (8), an enforcement authority may not give a penalty charge notice under this regulation after the end of the period of 28 days beginning with the contravention date ('the 28-day period')."*
>
> Source: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/uksi/2022/71/regulation/10

Exception — DVLA particulars not supplied in time

Value: 6 months beginning with the contravention date

> *"within the period of 14 days beginning with the contravention date, the enforcement authority has requested the Secretary of State to supply the relevant particulars in respect of the vehicle involved in the contravention, and … those particulars have not been supplied before the end of the 28-day period" … "in a case falling within paragraph (7)(a), for a period of six months beginning with the contravention date"*
>
> Source: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/uksi/2022/71/regulation/10

When a posted notice is treated as served

Value: Second working day after posting (so arrival can be ~30 days after the contravention)

> *"Service of such a notice or charge certificate contained in a letter sent by first class post which has been properly addressed, pre-paid and posted is to be taken to have been effected on the second working day after the day of posting."*
>
> Source: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/uksi/2022/71/regulation/3

Private car park (ANPR, no ticket on the windscreen) — England & Wales

Deadline to deliver the Notice to Keeper (ANPR case)

Value: 14 days beginning with the day after the parking ended

> *"sending it by post to a current address for service for the keeper so that it is delivered to that address within the relevant period." … "The relevant period for the purposes of sub-paragraph (4) is the period of 14 days beginning with the day after that on which the specified period of parking ended."*
>
> Source: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2012/9/schedule/4/paragraph/9

Deemed delivery of a posted keeper notice

Value: Second working day after posting

> *"A notice sent by post is to be presumed, unless the contrary is proved, to have been delivered (and so 'given' for the purposes of sub-paragraph (4)) on the second working day after the day on which it is posted"*

Source: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2012/9/schedule/4/paragraph/9

Private car park where a ticket WAS left on the windscreen

Deadline to deliver the Notice to Keeper (notice-to-driver case)

Value: 28 days following a period of 28 days beginning the day after the notice to driver was given (i.e. up to 56 days)

> *"The relevant period for the purposes of sub-paragraph (4) is the period of 28 days following the period of 28 days beginning with the day after that on which the notice to driver was given."*
>
> Source: https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2012/9/schedule/4/paragraph/8

Caveats

- The council rules above are the England regulations. Scotland and Wales run on different instruments; no primary source was fetched for them, so treat those jurisdictions as unverified here.
- These are the *issue/service* deadlines. The deadline for you to pay or challenge is separate (28 days from service, with a 14- or 21-day discount window).
- **Source:** No official source found (for the Scotland/Wales comparison and for the payment/appeal deadlines — no primary text was quoted for those).